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The Recruiter's Field Guide: A LinkedIn Profile Recruiters Find

How recruiters search LinkedIn for life sciences and behavioral health talent, and what to fix so your profile shows up. From Christina Smith, after 20+ years recruiting on the hiring side.

1. Get found in search EVERY PROFILE

- [ ] Headline: the title you want plus 2 or 3 search words, for example "Clinical Research Associate II | Oncology | Phase I to III" or "Qualified Professional | I/DD | Group Homes". You have 220 characters; use them.
- [ ] Current job title matches the market title, not an internal one. Recruiters filter on job title.
- [ ] Location is your real metro area (for example Raleigh-Durham). Many searches are filtered by location first.
- [ ] Skills section lists the exact words from postings you want, and your top skills are pinned.
- [ ] Open to Work is set to "Recruiters only" if you are employed, with your target titles, locations and work types filled in.

2. Get the click FIRST IMPRESSION

- [ ] A clear, current headshot and a banner that says what you do. Many recruiters skip profiles with no photo.
- [ ] About section opens with who you help and how, in 2 or 3 lines. Only the first lines show before "see more."
- [ ] Each recent role has 2 to 4 results with numbers, not a copy of your job description.
- [ ] Your contact settings let recruiters reach you (InMail and connection requests turned on).

3. Life sciences profiles CRA · QA · RA · MSL

- [ ] Name systems in Skills and in each role: Medidata Rave, Veeva Vault, CTMS, eTMF, TrackWise, SAP, LIMS.
- [ ] Name regulations you work under: GCP and ICH E6, GMP, 21 CFR Part 11. Only what you have applied.
- [ ] Therapeutic areas and phases in your headline or About (for example oncology, rare disease, Phase II).
- [ ] Certifications in Licenses & Certifications with the issuing body: ACRP-CP, CCRP, RAC, ASQ CQA.
- [ ] Keep sponsors confidential unless the partnership is public ("top-10 global pharma sponsor").

> **Recruiter tip:** search for your own target title on LinkedIn and open the first five profiles that come up. Notice the words in their headlines and skills. If those words are true for you and missing from your profile, add them.

Want a recruiter's eyes on your profile?

Ask your LinkedIn questions in the NeoHR Talent Network, or book a free career strategy session.

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The Recruiter's Field Guide: Behavioral Health LinkedIn Profiles

What recruiters for mental health, I/DD and substance use providers search for, from direct support to clinical and program leadership.

1. Credentials and populations EVERY PROFILE

- [ ] Licenses and credentials in your headline and in Licenses & Certifications, with state: LCSW, LCMHC, LCAS, LCSW-A, RN, CPSS. Add "eligible" or "in progress" with a date when that applies.
- [ ] Name the populations (mental health, I/DD, substance use) and ages you serve. Recruiters search these words.
- [ ] Name the settings: residential and group homes, day programs, outpatient, crisis, community-based services.
- [ ] Never post client names, photos or details that could identify someone you served.

2. Direct support and QPs DSP · QP

- [ ] DSPs: put "Direct Support Professional" in your headline, plus the population and shifts you are open to.
- [ ] List current trainings in Licenses & Certifications: CPR and First Aid, crisis prevention and de-escalation, medication administration.
- [ ] QPs: say how you qualify (your degree plus years with the population) and how many homes, staff or plans you oversee.

3. Clinicians, nurses and leaders CLINICAL · RN · LEADERSHIP

- [ ] Clinicians: modalities you are trained in and the populations you used them with, in Skills and in your About.
- [ ] Nurses: setting, census and medication or treatment oversight across sites.
- [ ] Leaders: census or capacity, staff led, budget, and licensure or accreditation survey results.
- [ ] Ask one supervisor or colleague for a recommendation that names your population and setting.

4. Stay visible 5 MINUTES A WEEK

- [ ] Comment on 2 or 3 posts from people in your field each week. It makes your name familiar to recruiters in your field.
- [ ] Follow the employers you want to work for so you see their openings first.
- [ ] Post your questions in the NeoHR Talent Network, where recruiters and HR folks in both fields can see them.

> **Recruiter tip:** behavioral health recruiters often search by credential plus location first ("LCMHC Raleigh"). If your credential and your city are not in your headline and location, you may not show up at all.

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